Apex Systems: Response to HCC-RFP-2026-014

Cloud-based Procurement Management Platform for Halcyon County Council · *Engineering-grade procurement platforms*

1. Executive Summary and Understanding of the Requirement

Apex Systems is pleased to respond to Halcyon County Council request HCC-RFP-2026-014 for a Cloud-based Procurement Management Platform. We understand the Council needs to replace spreadsheet-based purchasing with a single platform for requisitions, approvals, supplier onboarding, contracts and spend analytics.

Our proposal emphasises a robust technical architecture and security controls that exceed public sector expectations, delivered through a disciplined seven-month programme.

2. Proposed Solution and Architecture

The platform uses a cloud-native microservices architecture deployed on Kubernetes across three availability zones, with an API gateway exposing documented REST and GraphQL APIs.

Pre-built integration connectors for SAP S/4HANA, Oracle Fusion and Microsoft Dynamics synchronise purchase orders, invoices and supplier master data in near real time using an event-driven message bus.

Single sign-on is provided through SAML 2.0 and OpenID Connect integration with the Council's Azure AD tenant. The architecture scales horizontally and was load-tested at 50,000 concurrent users with p95 response times below 400 ms.

A 99.95% availability SLA is backed by active-active failover, automated backups every 15 minutes and a recovery point objective of 15 minutes.

The technical design includes a configurable workflow engine, an analytics data warehouse and an open integration framework so the Council can add new systems without vendor change requests.

3. Implementation Approach

Delivery follows a hybrid agile approach in four phases: discovery, configuration, integration and testing, and go-live. Each phase ends with a formal quality gate.

Data migration uses automated validation scripts with reconciliation reports signed off by the Council.

Timeline and Milestones

Milestone	When	Outcome
Discovery and design sign-off	Month 1–2	Architecture and integration design approved
Platform configuration	Month 3–4	Workflows, roles and catalogues configured
Integration and testing	Month 5–6	ERP integrations tested; security test passed
Go-live and hypercare	Month 7	Production launch with four weeks of hypercare

Team Structure

Role	Allocation	Responsibility
Programme Director	1.0 FTE	Overall delivery accountability
Solution Architect	1.0 FTE	Architecture and integration design
Integration Engineers	3.0 FTE	ERP and identity integrations
Security Lead	0.5 FTE	Security controls and assurance

Price Table

Item	Price (GBP)
Implementation and configuration	£420,000
Integration connectors (3 systems)	£180,000
Annual subscription (500 users) × 3 years	£780,000
Premium support and security monitoring × 3 years	£100,000
Total three-year cost	£1,480,000

Pricing assumptions

• Prices exclude VAT and are fixed for the three-year term.

• Additional integrations beyond the three named systems are charged at £60,000 each.

• Travel expenses are charged at cost.

4. Security, Compliance and Risk Controls

Apex Systems is ISO 27001 certified and holds a SOC 2 Type II report renewed annually; certificates are attached in Appendix C.

All data is encrypted at rest with AES-256 and in transit with TLS 1.3; encryption keys are managed in a hardware security module with quarterly key rotation.

We comply with UK GDPR and the Data Protection Act 2018, provide a signed data processing agreement, and host all Council data in UK data centres to guarantee data residency.

Role-based access control, multi-factor authentication and immutable audit logs record every approval and configuration change for full auditability.

Independent CREST-accredited penetration testing is performed twice a year and a 24x7 security operations centre monitors threats. Our risk register is reviewed monthly.

5. Support Model

Support is available 24x7 for priority 1 incidents with a one-hour response target; standard requests are handled during UK business hours.

6. Relevant Experience

We have delivered six similar procurement platforms for public sector and utility clients since 2019.

7. References

Client	Scope	Year
Northvale Water Authority	Procurement platform for 900 users	2023
Eastmoor Borough Council	Supplier portal and contract management	2024